Ears *open.*

A plan for each of the four parts, and how to make the most of hearing everything twice.

Four parts · about 30 minutes · 25 questions

THE PAPER AT A GLANCE

No. 02

What’s on the paper

4

parts: pictures, short chats, a talk and an interview

25

questions, one mark each

2×

Yes, really. You hear every recording twice.

6

minutes at the end to copy your answers onto the sheet

Write on the question paper while you listen. Tidy up later.

They won’t use *the words on the page.*

The question says “expensive”. The speaker says “it cost me a fortune”. If you hear the exact word from an option, be careful. It’s often a trap.

PART 1 · 7 QUESTIONS · CHOOSE A PICTURE

Look before you listen

1. Read the question and look at the three pictures.
2. What’s different between them? That’s what you listen for.
3. You’ll probably hear about all three. Only one is the answer.
4. Someone makes a suggestion? Wait for the reply.
5. Use the second listening to check.

Wait, they changed their mind

After these words, the next idea usually matters more:

but *actually* *although* *in the end* *instead*

“Let’s take the bus. Actually, no, the train’s quicker.”

How do they feel about it?

1. Read the first line: who's talking, and about what?
2. Read the question: a feeling, an opinion, or do they agree?
3. Listen to the end before you choose. People change their minds.
4. "Too expensive", "not big enough": someone isn't happy.
5. People agree without saying "I agree": *Exactly!* · *Tell me about it.*

You hear… it means

scary	frightening
not very interesting	boring
enormous	huge
I'm not so sure	I disagree
I couldn't believe it	surprised

PART 3 · 6 QUESTIONS · COMPLETE THE NOTES

No. 06

Guess first, then listen

1. Read the notes. Is each gap a number, a day, a place, a name?
2. The answers come in order, so follow along.
3. Write what you hear, usually one or two words.
4. Watch for corrections: “Friday… no, sorry, Thursday.”
5. On the second listening, check your spelling.

WRITE IT LIKE THIS

17th August

or 17/8 or Aug 17: all fine

£12.50 · 7.30

numbers in figures, not words

B–R–O–O–K–S

names are spelled out: know the alphabet

Let the interviewer guide you

1. Read all six questions first. Who is being interviewed?
2. When the interviewer asks something new, the next question is coming.
3. The options won’t use the speaker’s words.
4. Many questions are about feelings. Listen for the feeling and the reason.
5. Listen for time words: *then, now, since, for, before.*

Tense tells the story

She has worked there for two years.
She still works there.

She worked there for two years.
She doesn’t work there now.

Two chances. Use both.

1

First listening

Answer everything. Not sure? Put a little “?” next to it.

2

Second listening

Check your answers, especially the ones with a “?”.

6′

Copying time

Copy carefully. Check spelling and question numbers.

Missed one? Let it go and catch it the second time.

PRACTISING AT HOME

No. 09

Get used to English in your ears

- Do a practice test, then read the audioscript
- Find exactly where each answer was
- Notice the words that tricked you
- Dictate dates, prices and names with a friend
- Learn words together with their opposites
- Listen to something short in English every day

Wait for the end of the sentence.

Good luck.